PRAIRIE VIEW A&M UNIVERSITY

SYLLABUS

COMP 2310, Discrete Structures
FALL 2026

Instructor:	Suraiya Tairin
Section # and CRN:	P02 and 11178
Office Location:	S.R. Collins Room #318
Office Phone:	936 261 9872. Email is preferred.
Email Address:	sutairin@pvamu.edu
Office Hours:	T: 11:30 am – 2 pm R: 11:30 am – 2 pm Also available other times by appointment requests
Mode of Instruction:	Face to Face
Course Location:	S.R. Collins Room #226
Class Days & Times:	TR 9:30 am - 10:50 am
Catalog Description:	A bridge course between data structures/discrete mathematics and analysis of algorithms, to include reviews of functions and relations, basic combinatorics (set operations, counting, combinations, and permutations) and introductions to prepositional and predicate logic, discrete probability theory, recursive definitions, computational complexity, and proof techniques including mathematical induction. The concepts are illustrated by applications involving graphs, trees, networks and related algorithms.
Prerequisites:	(COMP 1422 or COMP 1224) or ((COMP 1221 or COMP 1122) and (COMP 1337 or COMP 1223))
Co-requisites:	None
Required Text(s):	Discrete Mathematical Structures, 6th edition, ISBN 978-0132297516. Author: Bernard Kolman, Robert C. Busby, Sharon Cutler Ross. Publisher: Pearson Prentice Hall.
Recommended Text(s):	

Course Learning Objectives:

	Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:	**Student Learning Outcome # Alignment**	**Core Curriculum Objective Alignment**
1	demonstrate knowledge and application of discrete mathematics	ABET outcome 1	Empirical and Quantitative skills
2	demonstrate knowledge and application of computing	ABET outcome 1	Empirical and Quantitative skills

Major Course Requirements

Method of Determining Final Course Grade

Item	Course Grade Requirement	Value	Total
1	Assignments (Approximately 5)	15%	15
2	Quizzes (Approximately 10)	20%	20
3	Mid-term exam	30%	20
4	Final exam	30%	30
5	Active class participation	5%	5
Total:		**100%**	**100**

Grading Criteria and Conversion:

A = 90% – 100%
B = 80% - 89%
C = 70% - 79%
D = 60% - 59%
F = Below 60%

If a student has stopped attending the course (i.e. "stopped out") at any point after the first day of class but did not officially withdraw from the course and has missed assignments and exams and performed below the grade level of a D, a grade of FN (failed-non attendance) will be assigned for the final course grade to ensure compliance with the Federal Title IV financial aid regulations. In contrast, if the student has completed all assignments and exams, but performed below the grade level of a D, a grade of F will be assigned for the final course grade.

Detailed Description of Major Assignments:

Assignment Title or Grade Requirement	Description
Assignments	There will be approximately five (5) written assignments based on the class materials covered. Each assignment will contribute 3% to the overall grade, amounting to a total of 15% for all assignments combined.
Quizzes	There will be approximately 10 quizzes with 5 multiple-choice questions. Quizzes will be on the materials that have been covered in the previous classes. It is very important that you attend the class regularly and pay close attention to the delivery of the materials.
Mid-term exam	Based on the materials covered from week 1 to 6
Final exam	Based on all the materials covered throughout the course
Active class participation	You are expected to actively participate in activities including but not limited to: i. analytical discussion ii. contributing to critical thinking iii. presenting your ideas and thoughts Each active participation with **reasonable** discussions/thoughts/ideas is worth 1 point. Therefore, to receive full marks, you must engage at least 5 times throughout the semester.

Course Procedures or Additional Instructor Policies

Assignment submission criteria:

1. Please make sure to submit your assignments in the following format "**Your First Name_Your Last Name_Assignment title.pdf**".

For example, if your first name is "John" and your last name is "Doe" and you are turning in "Assignment 1", the file name should be as follows,
"**John_Doe_Assignment1.pdf**".

2. Assignments should be uploaded electronically on Canvas. After you upload your assignments, please make sure Canvas can render them and you can download/view the assignment properly.
3. All assignments are due by 11:59 pm on the specified date. Late submissions are accepted up to 5 days after the deadline and penalized by 10% for each day.

Exam policy

There will be no make-up assignments/quizzes/exams in this course due to missed classes. Please contact me in advance if you are unable to take a quiz or exam. You will need to provide a reasonable explanation with proof for making up a missed assignment/quiz/exam. Please see the student handbook for acceptable excuses.

In Class

The use of headphones, music players, and cellular phones for texting or browsing is prohibited during the class. Failure to do so may result in losing attendance credit. It is the responsibility of students to obtain any assignments, class notes, and materials from classmates if they miss a class. The student is responsible for obtaining and studying all information covered in class.

Communication

For problems related to the course, please visit me during my office hours. If you need additional help outside the office hours, you may request an appointment. Additionally, you may always reach out to me via email. You should receive a response within 24 hours of sending me an email (this does not include weekends/holidays/university breaks). If you do not receive a response, please remind me after the 24-hour period has passed.

Semester Calendar (Tentative)

Lecture contents			Homework	Quizzes
Week 1 Aug 24 – 30	Lecture 1	i. Course introduction, syllabus discussion, policy, and guidelines ii. Chapter 1: Fundamentals a. Section 1.1: Sets and Subsets		
	Lecture 2	i. Chapter 1: Fundamentals a. Section 1.2: Operations on Sets		
Week 2	Lecture 1	i. Chapter 1: Fundamentals a. Section 1.3: Sequence b. Section 1.4: Properties of the Integers		Quiz 1
	Lecture 2	i. Chapter 1: Fundamentals a. Section 1.5: Matrices b. Section 1.6: Mathematical Structures	Homework 1 released	
Week 3	Lecture 1	ii. Chapter 2: Logic a. Section 2.1: Propositions and Logical Operations b. Section 2.2: Conditional Statements		Quiz 2
	Lecture 2	iii. Chapter 2: Logic a. Section 2.3: Methods of Proofs b. Section 2.4: Mathematical Induction		

Week 4	Lecture 1	i. Chapter 2: Logic a. Section 2.5: Mathematical Statements		Quiz 3
	Lecture 2	i. Chapter 2: a. Section 2.6: Logic and Problem Solving	Homework 2 released	
Week 5	Lecture 1	i. Chapter 3: Counting a. Section 3.1: Permutation b. Section 3.2: Combination		Quiz 4
	Lecture 2	i. Chapter 3: Counting a. Section 3.3: Pigeonhole Principle		
Week 6	Lecture 1	i. Chapter 3: Counting a. Section 3.4: Elements of Probability		Quiz 5
	Lecture 2	i. Chapter 3: Counting a. Section 3.5: Recurrence Relations	Homework 3 released	
Week 7	Lecture 1	i. Chapter 4: Relations and Digraphs a. Section 4.1: Product Sets and Partitions b. Section 4.2: Relations and Digraphs		
	Lecture 2	i. Chapter 4: Relations and Digraphs a. Section 4.3: Paths in Relations and Digraphs b. Section 4.4: Properties of Relations		
Week 8 Oct 13 - 17	Day 1	Mid-term review		
	Oct 15	**Mid-term exam**		
Week 9	Lecture 1	i. Chapter 4: Relations and Digraphs a. Section 4.5: Equivalence Relation b. Section 4.6: Data Structures for Relations and Digraphs		Quiz 6
	Lecture 2	i. Chapter 4: Relations and Digraphs a. Section 4.7: Operations on Relations b. Section 4.8: Transitive Closure and Warshall's Algorithm		
Week 10	Lecture 1	i. Chapter 5: Functions a. Section 5.1: Functions b. Section 5.2: Functions for Computer Science		Quiz 7
	Lecture 2	i. Chapter 5: Functions a. Section 5.3: Growth of Functions b. Section 5.4: Permutation Functions	Homework 4 released	
Week 11	Lecture 1	i. Chapter 7: Trees a. Section 7.1: Trees b. Section 7.2: Labeled trees		Quiz 8
	Lecture 2	i. Chapter 7: Trees a. Section 7.3: Tree Searching		

Week 12	Lecture 1	i. Chapter 7: Trees a. Section 7.4: Undirected Trees		Quiz 9
	Lecture 2	i. Chapter 8: Topics in Graph Theory a. Section 8.1: Graphs b. Section 8.2: Euler Paths and Circuits	Homework 5 released	
Week 13	Lecture 1	i. Chapter 8: Topics in Graph Theory a. Section 8.3: Hamiltonian Paths and Circuits b. Section 8.4: Transport Network		Quiz 10
	Lecture 2	i. Chapter 8: Topics in Graph Theory a. Section 8.5: Matching Problems		
Week 14 Nov 25 - 30	Day 1	i. Chapter 8: Topics in Graph Theory a. Section 8.6: Coloring Graphs		
	Day 2	**Final exam review**		
Week 15 Dec 1	**No class, Reading day**			
Week 15, 16 Dec 2 - 9	**Final exam week. The exact date and time will be notified later.**			

Student Support and Success

John B. Coleman Library

The John B. Coleman Library's mission is to enhance the scholarly pursuit of knowledge, to foster intellectual curiosity, and to promote life-long learning and research through our innovative services, resources, and cultural programs, which support Prairie View A&M University's global mission of teaching, service, and research. It maintains library collections and access both on campus, online, and through local agreements to further the educational goals of students and faculty. Library Website; Phone: 936-261-1500

Academic Advising Services

Academic Advising Services offers students various services that contribute to student success and lead toward graduation. We assist students with understanding university policies and procedures that affect academic progress. We support the early alert program to help students connect to success early in the semester. We help refer students to the appropriate academic support services when they are unsure of the best resource for their needs. Advisors within Academic Advising Services are available to all students. We are located across campus. Find your advisor's location by academic major on the advising website. Phone: 936-261-5911

The University Tutoring Center

The University Tutoring Center (UTC) offers free tutoring and academic support to all registered PVAMU students. The mission of the UTC is to help provide a solid academic foundation that enables students to become confident, capable, independent learners. Competent and caring staff and peer tutors guide students in identifying, acquiring, and enhancing the knowledge, skills, and attitudes needed to reach their desired goals. Tutoring and academic support are offered face-to-face in the UTC and virtually in online sessions. Other support services available for students include Supplemental Instruction, Study Breaks, Academic Success Workshops, and Algebra Study Jam. Location: J. B. Coleman Library, Rm. 307; Phone: 936-261-1561; Email: pvtutoring@pvamu.edu; University Tutoring Website

Writing Center

The Writing Center provides well-trained peer tutors to assist students with writing assignments at any stage of the writing process. Tutors help students with various writing tasks, including understanding assignments, brainstorming, drafting, revising, editing, researching, and integrating sources. Students have free access to Grammarly online writing assistance. Grammarly is an automated proofreading and plagiarism detection tool. Students must register for Grammarly by using their student email address. In addition, students have access to face-to-face and virtual tutoring services either asynchronously via email or synchronously via Zoom. Location: J. B. Coleman Library, Rm. 209; Phone: 936-261-3724; Writing Center Website; Grammarly Registration

Panther Navigate

Panther Navigate is a proactive system of communication and collaboration between faculty, academic advisors, and students that is designed to support student success by promptly identifying issues and allowing for intervention. Panther Navigate helps students by providing a central location to schedule advising appointments, view campus resources, and request assistance. Students who recognize that they have a problem that negatively affects their academic performance or ability to continue school may self-refer an academic early alert. To do so, students will log in to Canvas and click on Student Alerts on the left sidebar within a course. Students also have the option to download the Navigate Student app. Phone: 936-261-5902; Panther Navigate Website.

While Panther Navigate is designed for early, proactive support, students with a specific academic grievance should first contact the instructor and academic advisor; if unresolved, the matter may be directed to the Department Head and/or Academic Dean, and ultimately to the Office of the Provost through an Academic Conference Request.

Student Health

Students have access to medical care by appointment Monday–Friday from 8 am-5 pm. The clinic closes daily for lunch from 12 pm-1 pm. The clinic offers women's health, sexual health, physicals, and other ambulatory care. Students also have access virtually to behavioral and physical health support, 365 days 24/7, via Timelycare. Timelycare can be used on the weekends, after hours, while traveling, and back home while on break. Location: Owens Franklin Health Center, 1st floor; Call for an Appointment: 936-261-1410; Health Services Website

Student Counseling Services

The Student Counseling Services offers a range of services and programs to assist students in maximizing their potential for success: short-term individual, couples, and group counseling, as well as crisis intervention, outreach, consultation, and referral services. The staff is licensed by the State of Texas and assists students who are dealing with academic skills concerns, situational crises, adjustment problems, and emotional difficulties. Information shared with the staff is treated confidentially and in accordance with Texas State Law. Location: Owens Franklin Health Center, Suite 226; Phone: 936-261-3564; Health & Counseling Center Website

Mental Health Telehealth Resources

Prairie View A&M University is committed to supporting student well-being. Students have free access to TELUS Health Student Support, available 24/7/365, providing confidential support, wellness resources, and access to professional counselors through phone and chat services.

Office of Testing Services

The Office of Testing Services serves to facilitate and protect the administration of educational and professional exams to aid students, faculty, staff, and the community in their academic and career goals. We provide proctoring services for individuals who need to take exams for distance or correspondence courses for another institution, exams for independent study courses, or make-up exams. In order for a proctored exam to be administered by our office, the instructor of the course must first submit the online PVAMU Testing Services – Test Proctoring Form (this form can only be completed by the instructor) to the Office of Testing Services 72 hours prior to the first exam being administered. Once the Test Proctoring Form has been submitted, the instructor will inform their testers so they can then register for an appointment with our office on one of the selected proctored exam test dates within the testing window for the exam and pay the applicable fees. To access the OTS – Test Proctoring Form, to schedule a proctored exam appointment, or to find more information about our proctoring services, please visit the OTS – Proctoring Service website. Location: Wilhelmina Delco, 3rd Floor, Rm. 305; Phone: 936-261-3627; Email: aetesting@pvamu.edu; Testing Website

Office of Disability Services

The Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) is a federal civil rights law that prohibits discrimination against individuals with disabilities. In accordance with the ADA and other applicable laws, the university is committed to providing reasonable accommodations that ensure equal access to educational programs, services, and activities for students with documented disabilities. If you believe you have a disability and require accommodations, please visit the Accommodate online platform to register and submit the required documentation. Once your documentation is reviewed, you will be contacted regarding the accommodation process and available support services. Location: Owens Franklin Health Center, Rm 222; Phone: 936-261-3583; Disability Services Website

Center for Instructional Innovation and Technology Services (CIITS)

Distance Learning, also referred to as Distance Education, is the employment of alternative instructional delivery methods to extend programs and services to people unable to attend classes in the traditional manner. CIITS supports student learning through online, hybrid, web-assisted, and 2-way video course delivery. For more details and contact information, visit CIITS Student Website. Phone: 936-261-3283 or email: ciits@pvamu.edu.

Veteran Affairs

Veteran Services works with student veterans, current military, and military dependents to support their transition to the college environment and continued persistence to graduation. The Office coordinates and certifies benefits for both the G.I. Bill and the Texas Hazlewood Act. Location: Evans Hall, Rm. 102; Phone: 936-261-3563; Veteran Affairs Website

Office for Student Engagement

The Office for Student Engagement delivers comprehensive programs and services designed to meet the co-curricular needs of students. The Office implements inclusive and accessible programs and services that enhance student development through exposure to and participation in diverse and relevant social, cultural, intellectual, recreational, community service, leadership development, and campus governance. Location: Memorial Student Center, Rm. 221; Phone: 936-261-1340; Student Engagement Website

Center for Careers & Professional Development

This center supports students through professional development, career readiness, and placement and employment assistance. The center provides one-on-one career coaching, interview preparation, resume and letter writing, and career exploration workshops and seminars. Services are provided for students at the Northwest Houston Center and College of Nursing in the Medical Center twice a month or on a requested basis. Distance Learning students are encouraged to visit the center website for information regarding services provided. Location: Anderson Hall, 2nd floor; Phone: 936-261-3570; Center for Careers & Professional Development Website

Student Life Resource Center

The Student Life Resource Center provides currently enrolled students with free resources and individualized support to address food insecurity, housing instability, and other basic needs. Available services include nutritious food, casual and business-casual clothing, personal hygiene products, case management, and referrals to campus and community resources for housing, childcare, financial assistance, and other essential needs. Students seeking food and pantry assistance must complete the required Student Intake Form before receiving services. Location: Owens Franklin Health Center, Basement, Room 025; Phone: 936-261-1419; Email: hilltopreserve@pvamu.edu; Student Life Resource Center

Panthers Fostering Success

Panthers Fostering Success provides individualized support to currently enrolled students who have experienced foster care, adoption, guardianship, homelessness, or housing instability. The program helps students navigate college successfully by offering case management, mentoring, resource coordination, academic and personal development workshops, emergency resource referrals, and opportunities to build community and meaningful connections. Students are encouraged to complete the program's intake form to receive personalized assistance and access available campus and community resources. Location: Anderson Hall, Room 111; Phone: 936-261-5920; Email: pfs@pvamu.edu; Panthers Fostering Success

Student Advocate

The Student Advocate helps PVAMU students identify resources and campus partners to help them navigate through the University and resolve barriers to their success. Location: AI Thomas Building, Suite 013; Phone: 936-261-2124; Student Advocate Website

Student Government Association (SGA)

The Prairie View A&M University Student Government Association is the official voice of the student body, representing student interests and perspectives to university administration, faculty, and academic units. SGA advocates for student needs, leads student-centered initiatives, and provides leadership development opportunities that support student success and shared governance across campus. Location: Willie A. Tempton Memorial Student Center (MSC), 2nd Floor; Email: sga@pvamu.edu; Student Government Association Website

University Rules and Procedures

Academic Misconduct

Academic dishonesty is defined as any form of cheating or dishonesty that has the effect or intent of interfering with any academic exercise or fair evaluation of a student's performance. The faculty can provide additional information, particularly related to a specific course, laboratory, or assignment.

You are expected to practice academic honesty in every aspect of this course and all other courses. Make sure you are familiar with the *University Administrative Guidelines on Academic Integrity*, which can be found on the Academic

Integrity webpage. Students who engage in academic misconduct are subject to university disciplinary procedures. As listed in the *University Administrative Guidelines on Academic Integrity*, the University Online Catalog, and the Student Code of Conduct, the following are examples of prohibited conduct. This list is not designed to be all-inclusive or exhaustive. In addition to academic sanctions, any student found to have committed academic misconduct that is also a violation of criminal law may also be subject to disciplinary review and action by the Office of Student Conduct (as outlined in the Student Code of Conduct).

Forms of Academic Dishonesty:

1. Cheating: Deception in which a student misrepresents that they have mastered information, skills, or competencies on an academic exercise that they have not genuinely learned or developed. This includes giving, receiving or using aid unauthorized by the instructor on assignments or examinations, whether from human sources, automated tools, or assistive, analytical, or generative artificial intelligence systems.
2. Plagiarism: Careless or deliberate use of the work or the ideas of another; representation of another's work, words, ideas, or data as your own without permission or appropriate acknowledgment. Examples: copying another's paper or answers, failure to identify information or essays from the internet and submitting or representing it as your own; submitting an assignment which has been partially or wholly done by another and claiming it as yours; not properly acknowledging a source which has been summarized or paraphrased in your work; failure to acknowledge the use of another's words with quotation marks;
3. Collusion: When more than one student or person contributes to a piece of work that is submitted as the work of an individual;
4. Conspiracy: Agreeing with one or more people to commit an act of academic/scholastic dishonesty; and
5. Multiple Submission: Submission of work from one course to satisfy a requirement in another course without explicit permission. Example: using a paper prepared and graded for credit in one course to fulfill a requirement and receive credit in a different course.

PVAMU General Statement on the Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence Tools in the Classroom

This statement applies to all current and future Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) tools (including but not limited to ChatGPT), which refer to technologies capable of producing text, computer code, images, audio, video, or other content in response to user prompts. The University expects all work submitted for academic credit — whether in a face-to-face, hybrid, or online course — to reflect the student's own knowledge, skills, analysis, and effort. The use of GenAI is permitted only when expressly authorized by the instructor and must comply with the requirements established for the course or assignment, as well as System Regulation 29.01.05, Artificial Intelligence. When authorized, GenAI may be used only as a supplemental resource and may not replace the student's original thinking, analysis, research, or authorship. Students are responsible for reviewing, verifying, and appropriately acknowledging any AI-generated content used in their work. Submitting AI-generated content as one's own, using GenAI when it is prohibited, or failing to disclose its use when required may constitute a violation of the University's Administrative Guidelines on Academic Integrity and its underlying academic values. Because expectations may vary by course and assignment, students should consult the instructor before using any GenAI tool when permission is unclear.

Nonacademic Misconduct

The university respects the rights of instructors to teach and students to learn. Maintenance of these rights requires campus conditions that do not impede their exercise. Campus behavior that interferes with either (1) the instructor's ability to conduct the class, (2) the ability of other students to profit from the instructional program, or (3) campus behavior that interferes with the rights of others will not be tolerated. An individual engaging in such disruptive behavior may be subject to disciplinary action. The Office of Student Conduct will adjudicate such incidents under nonacademic procedures. Student Code of Conduct – Student Affairs

Sexual Misconduct

Sexual harassment of students and employees at Prairie View A&M University is unacceptable and will not be tolerated. Any member of the university community violating the university's sexual misconduct policy will be subject to disciplinary action. In accordance with the Texas A&M University System guidelines, your instructor is obligated to

report to the Office of Title IX Compliance (titleixteam@pvamu.edu) any instance of sexual misconduct involving a student, which includes sexual assault, stalking, dating violence, domestic violence, sex-based discrimination, and sexual harassment, about which the instructor becomes aware during this course through writing, discussion, or personal disclosure. The faculty and staff of PVAMU actively strive to provide a learning, working, and living environment that promotes respect that is free from sexual misconduct, discrimination, and all forms of violence. If students, faculty, or staff would like assistance or have questions, they may contact the Title IX Coordinator, Dr. Zakiya Brown, at 936-261-2166 or titleixteam@pvamu.edu. More information can be found at Title IX Website, including confidential resources available on campus.

Protections and Accommodations for Pregnant and Parenting Students

The U.S. Department of Education's Office for Civil Rights (OCR) enforces, among other statutes, Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972. Title IX protects people from discrimination based on sex in education programs or activities that receive federal financial assistance. This protection includes those who may be pregnant and parenting. Title IX states: "No person in the United States shall, on the basis of sex, be excluded from participation in, be denied the benefits of, or be subjected to discrimination under any education program or activity receiving Federal financial assistance." Students seeking accommodations, including excused absences, related to a pregnancy or parenting status should contact the Office of Title IX for information, resources, and support at titleixteam@pvamu.edu or visit the office's Pregnancy & Parenting Student Resource Page. The QR code below will take you to the support request form. Additional information and/or support may be provided by the Office of Disability Services or the Office of the Dean of Students.

Non-Discrimination Statement

Prairie View A&M University does not discriminate on the basis of race, color, sex, religion, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, veteran status, sexual orientation, or gender identity in its programs and activities. The University is committed to supporting students and complying with The Texas A&M University System's non-discrimination policy. It seeks to establish an environment that is free of bias, discrimination, and harassment. If you experience an incident of discrimination or harassment, we encourage you to report it. If you would like to speak with someone who may be able to afford you privacy or confidentiality, there are individuals who can meet with you. The Director for Title IX Compliance and Director of Employee Services & Workplace Integrity have been designated to handle inquiries regarding the non-discrimination policies. Dr. Zakiya Brown, Director of Title IX Compliance, can be reached at Harrington Science Building, Suite 311 or by phone (936) 261-2166 or by email at ztbrown@pvamu.edu and the Director of Employee Services & Workplace Integrity, Ms. Latoya Douglas, can be reached at Harrington Science Building, Suite 109, or by phone at 936-261-1792 or by email at lvdouglas@pvamu.edu.

Class Attendance Policy (See the University Online Catalog for Full Attendance Policy)

Prairie View A&M University requires regular class attendance. Attending all classes supports the full academic development of each learner, whether classes are taught with the instructor physically present or via distance learning technologies such as interactive video and/or the Internet. Excessive absenteeism, whether excused or unexcused, may result in a student's course grade being reduced or in the assignment of a grade of "F." Absences are accumulated beginning with the first day of class during regular semesters and summer terms. Each faculty member will include the University's attendance policy in each course syllabus.

Makeup Work for Legitimate Absences

Prairie View A&M University recognizes that there are a variety of legitimate circumstances in which students will miss coursework and that accommodations for makeup work will be made. If a student's absence is **excused**, the instructor must either provide the student an opportunity to make up any quiz, exam, or other work contributing to the final grade or provide a satisfactory alternative by a date agreed upon by the student and instructor. Students are encouraged to work with instructors to complete makeup work before known scheduled absences (University-sponsored events, administrative proceedings, etc.). Students are responsible for planning their schedules to avoid excessive conflicts with course requirements.

Absence Verification Process

All non-athletic absences (e.g., Medical, Death/Funeral, Court/Legal-related, etc.) for which a student seeks to obtain a valid excuse must be submitted to the Office for Dean of Students with supporting documentation, for review and verification. Please use the Online Reporting Forms to access/complete/submit the *Request for a University Excused Absence* form for an excuse. Upon receipt, a staff member will verify the documentation and provide an official university excuse, if applicable. The student is responsible for providing the official university excuse issued by the Office for Dean of Students to the professor(s). Questions should be directed to the Dean of Students via email: deanofstudents@pvamu.edu or phone: (936) 261-3550.

Student Academic Appeals Process

Authority and responsibility for assigning grades to students rest with the faculty. However, in those instances where students believe that miscommunication, errors, or unfairness of any kind may have adversely affected the instructor's assessment of their academic performance, the student has a right to appeal by the procedure listed in the University Online Catalog and by doing so within thirty days of receiving the grade or experiencing any other problematic academic event that prompted the complaint.

Statement on Classroom Recordings

Recording of lectures, discussions, or any course-related activity is not permitted. Students may record only with written official authorization obtained in advance (for example, as part of a documented student accommodation).

Technical Considerations

***Minimum* Recommended Hardware and Software:**

- Intel PC or laptop with Windows 10 or later version; Mac with OS Catalina
- Smartphone, iPad, or tablet with wi-fi capability*
- Reliable high-speed internet access
- 8 GB memory
- 320 GB of available storage
- 15-inch or larger color monitor with a minimum resolution of 1024 x 768
- Speakers (internal or external)
- Microphone and recording software, when required
- Keyboard and mouse
- Most current version of Google Chrome, Safari, or Mozilla Firefox

Browser Settings: Enable pop-ups and any browser preferences required for course applications.

* Some courses may require remote proctoring. At this time, only Chromebooks, laptops, and desktops running Windows or Mac work with our proctoring solution, but iPads are not compatible. Most other applications will work with Android or Apple tablets and smartphones.

Minimum Computer Skills

Students should have basic proficiency in the following areas:

- Sending and receiving email
- Navigating the internet
- Creating and editing documents in Microsoft Word or a compatible program
- Opening and reviewing PDF documents using Adobe Acrobat Reader or a similar application
- Using Windows or macOS
- Participating in video conference using Zoom or other approved platforms

Netiquette

Students are expected to participate in all discussions, virtual class meetings, and course-related chats as directed. Students are to be respectful and courteous to others on discussion boards. Foul, abusive, threatening, discriminatory, or otherwise inappropriate language will not be tolerated. Do not use ALL CAPS for communicating with others, AS IT CAN BE INTERPRETED AS YELLING. Avoid slang terms such as "wassup?" and texting abbreviations such as "u" instead of "you." Use emoticons and humor or sarcasm with caution, as tone is sometimes

lost in an email or discussion post, and the message might be taken seriously or sound offensive.

Video Conferencing Etiquette

When participating in Zoom, Webex, or another video conferencing platform:

- Select a quiet location with minimal background noise and distractions.
- Ensure the visible background is orderly and free from inappropriate or offensive materials.
- Dress appropriately for an academic setting.
- Keep your microphone muted when you are not speaking.
- Avoid eating or engaging in distracting activities during the session.
- Test your internet connection, microphone, camera, lighting, and speakers before the class begins.
- Follow all additional participation expectations established by the instructor.

Technical Support

Students should go to Password Reset Tool if they have password issues. The site provides instructions for resetting passwords and contact information for additional assistance if login issues persist. For technical assistance with eCourses, students should contact the Center for Instructional Innovation and Technology Services (936-261-3283; ciits@pvamu.edu).

Communication Expectations and Standards

The instructor will generally respond to emails and discussion posts within 48 hours, excluding weekends, holidays, and University closures. Messages requiring prompt attention should be clearly identified as urgent when appropriate. Students are responsible for regularly checking their University email, course announcements, discussion boards, and other course communication channels for responses and updates.

Discussion Requirement

Online courses often require minimal to no face-to-face meetings. However, conversations about the readings, lectures, materials, and other aspects of the course can occur in a seminar fashion. The use of the discussion board will accomplish this. The instructor will determine the exact use of discussion boards.

It is strongly suggested that students type their discussion postings in a word processing application such as Word and save them to their PC or a removable drive before posting to the discussion board. This is important for two reasons: 1) If, for some reason, your discussion responses are lost in your online course, you will have another copy; 2) Grammatical errors can be greatly minimized by the use of the spell-and-grammar check functions in word processing applications. Once the post(s) have been typed and corrected in the word processing application, copy and paste to the discussion board.